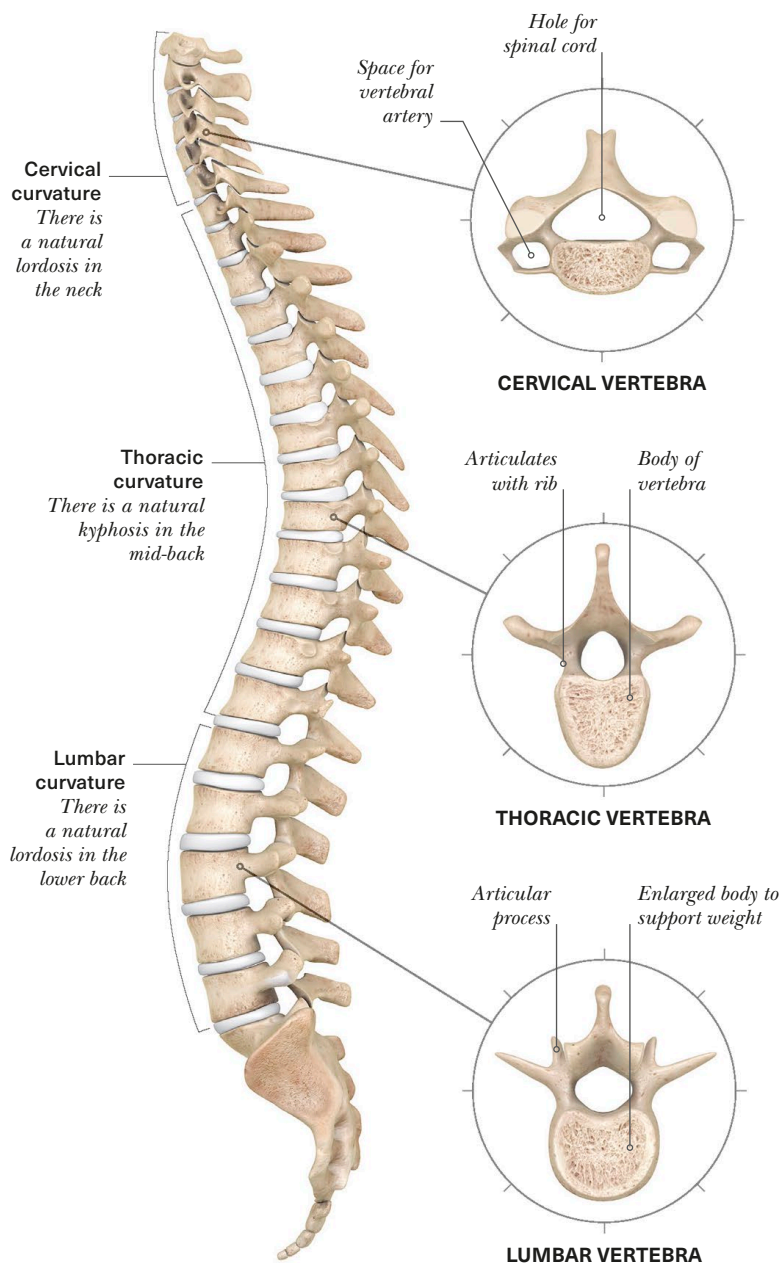


SPINE

Your vertebrae sit on top of each other to create natural curves. This is called a “neutral spine.” It alternates between curving inward (lordosis) and outward (kyphosis) to absorb shock like a coiled spring. Your vertebrae are like wedges stacked to form these curves in order to bear your body weight most efficiently.



Neutral spine

Many asanas incorporate a neutral spine, such as seated meditation poses. Poor posture and other considerations can lead to a multitude of spinal structural deviations, including common conditions like hyperlordosis and hyperkyphosis. Yoga works your spine in unique ways and enhances body awareness to improve your overall posture.



Gentle, even curves

NEUTRAL SPINE

These natural curves create the strongest, most stable alignment of the spine. In this ideal, the spine is also not twisted or leaning to either side.



Curvature in upper spinal column

KYPHOSIS

Hyperkyphosis of the thoracic spine is often simply called a kyphosis or hunchback. This exaggerated curvature is common in osteoporosis.



Curvature in lower spinal column

LORDOSIS

Hyperlordosis of the lumbar spine is sometimes just called a lordosis or swayback. This exaggerated curvature is natural during pregnancy.